

Question:

A research team is studying the effects of a novel drug that was discovered to treat type 2 diabetes. In order to learn more about its effects, they follow patients who are currently taking the drug and determine whether there are adverse effects that exceed anticipated levels and may therefore be drug-related. They discover that the drug causes an excess of sudden cardiac death in 19 patients with renal failure out of 2 million total patients that are followed. Based on these results, an additional warning about this serious adverse effect is added to the investigator brochure for the drug. Which of the following clinical phase studies does this study most likely describe? Answer Choices: A. Phase I B. Phase II C. Phase III D. Phase IV E. Phase V

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>The study describes a follow-up to a large number of patients who are currently taking the drug to determine if there are any adverse effects. This suggests a post-market surveillance study, which typically occurs during Phase IV. Phase II and Phase III studies usually have smaller sample sizes and focus on the efficacy and safety of the drug in a more controlled environment. Phase V studies are not a standard phase in drug development and typically refer to additional studies conducted after approval for marketing. </think> <answer> D. Phase IV </answer>

